

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 841

By Roberts

A RESOLUTION to honor Irene Ward upon her exemplary service to the Senate on the occasion of her retirement.

WHEREAS, the members of the General Assembly wish to recognize a highly skilled and talented professional who, throughout her long and distinguished tenure with the legislature, evidenced the dedication and excellence of a true public servant; and

WHEREAS, Irene Ward retired from the General Assembly on August 15, 2025, after thirty-eight years of meritorious service to the Senate; and

WHEREAS, Irene Ward is a native Nashvillian whose family has longstanding ties to the city and its business, civic, and social communities; and

WHEREAS, a graduate of Hollins College, Irene Ward worked in several jobs before finding her true métier with Senator Douglas Henry in 1972; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Ward served as Senator Henry's personal administrative assistant for fifteen years before joining the legislative staff in July 1987; and

WHEREAS, until Senator Henry's retirement in 2014, Irene Ward was his right-hand, Girl Friday, advisor, confidante, and friend, serving as a vital component of his legislative office; and

WHEREAS, she then worked for the Senate Clerk's office for the remainder of her career, working out of the office of Senator Kerry Roberts until the General Assembly moved to the Cordell Hull Building in 2017; and

WHEREAS, Irene Ward manned the first floor help desk at the Cordell Hull Building, assisting lobbyists, staff members, constituents, and other visitors find their way and providing essential information to the public; and

WHEREAS, Irene Ward brought immense positivity to her final legislative assignment through her warm and friendly demeanor; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Ward consistently upheld the highest standards of integrity while working for the Senate, demonstrating a strong commitment to ethical principles, both in her work and her personal conduct; and

WHEREAS, beyond her professional excellence, Irene Ward is a genuine and intentional friend; she brought smiles to people throughout the legislative complex and built meaningful, lasting friendships with her colleagues; and

WHEREAS, Irene Ward exemplifies the spirit and allegiance to community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, throughout her estimable career, Irene Ward demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity, winning the unbridled respect and admiration of her colleagues and legislators alike; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Irene Ward upon her exemplary service to the Senate, thank her for making the General Assembly a more joyful workplace, and extend to her our heartfelt wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement and every continued success in her future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.